Assignment 6 Postmortem

My Favorite Cats Website

1. Project Goals & Outcomes

My goal was to create a fun and welcoming website about my three favorite cats, Honey, Maple, and Bennie. It was designed for cat lovers and anyone interested in learning about their personalities. I wanted the website to feel playful and personal while still being organized and responsive on desktop, tablet, and mobile screens.

I think the final website met these goals well. The soft color palette, symbols, photos, and casual descriptions match the cute subject of the site. I'm especially happy with the "Meet the Cats" section. Each cat has a card with the same basic structure, which makes their information easy to read and compare. The cards also adjust to different screen sizes.

2. Development Process

One decision that worked well was creating a reusable card design. After building the first card, I could use the same structure for the other cats and simply change the content. This saved time and made the website feel consistent.

Using CSS Grid also worked well. It allowed the cards to appear next to each other on larger screens and stack on smaller screens. This gave me more flexibility than positioning every card separately.

One thing I would reconsider is how early I focused on decorative details. I enjoyed choosing colors and symbols, but I should have tested the main layout more often before polishing its appearance. This project showed me that I work best when I create a clear structure first and add creative details afterward.

3. Critique & Insights

Gwen's feedback helped confirm that my visual choices supported the website's purpose. She said the images loaded quickly and clearly and that the color palette fit the playful and cute personalities of the cats. I was glad to hear this because creating that mood was one of my main goals.

Her accessibility suggestion was also helpful. She recommended making the images on the "Cat Info" page smaller. This could reduce the amount of scrolling and leave room to add more cat photos later. Her comment made me think more carefully about the difference between an image looking good by itself and fitting comfortably into the full page.

Reviewing other websites also reminded me that visitors usually scan a page quickly. Clear headings, consistent spacing, and appropriately sized images make a website easier to use. If I

continued developing my site, I would prioritize reducing the image sizes and checking their proportions at different screen widths.

Gwen also liked my idea for a cat personality quiz and said she would use it if I added it. This showed me that the quiz could make the website more interactive instead of only presenting information. It would give visitors a fun reason to spend more time on the site.

4. Looking Forward

For future projects, I want to keep using reusable components when information follows the same pattern. This saves time, creates consistency, and makes later changes easier. I also want to test my work at different screen sizes throughout development instead of waiting until the end.

When working with a client, I would spend more time confirming their goals before beginning the visual design. I would ask about their audience, required content, preferred style, and accessibility needs. I would also share progress earlier so the client could respond before the website was almost finished.

These practices would help me catch problems sooner and avoid unnecessary revisions. They would also help me make choices based on the client's needs rather than only my own preferences.

5. Final Project Reflection

One thing I want to remember for my next project is to consider how every design choice affects the full user experience, not just how it looks.

For example, large images can be attractive and clear, but they can also create unnecessary scrolling. In my next project, I want to build the main layout, add the actual content, and test it at several screen sizes before focusing on smaller design details. This will help me create a website that feels personal while also being easy and comfortable to use.